carrying out armed struggle both against the KMT and the Japanese and in establishing the People's Republic of China in 1949. It reaffirms the whole body of Mao Zedong Thought as the creative application of Marxism–Leninism to the actual conditions in China and credits the early successes of the country in achieving national unity, political stability and economic recovery to his leadership. It is the latter period of Mao's leadership, from 1959 onwards, which is described as a period of chaos and destruction and linked to his growing personality cult and rejection of the principle of collective leadership.

While the Resolution is focused on the history of the Party since the establishment of the PRC, it also covers in outline the period from the founding of the Party in 1921. It follows the chronology of the 1945 Resolution, but picks up the story from where the latter concludes, with a narrative of the 1945–49 civil war and the eventual victory of the communist forces after twenty-eight years of struggle. The credit is given to Marxism–Leninism and its creative application to Chinese conditions, which has now been systematized in the 'great system of Mao Zedong Thought'.

The liberation of China in 1949 is described as 'the most important political event since the end of the World War Two and [which] has exerted a profound and far-reaching impact on the international situation and the development of the people's struggle throughout the world'. [2]

Unlike the 1945 Resolution, we see a more explicit awareness of the geopolitical implications of what the CPC had achieved in this Resolution.

The 1981 Resolution is remarkable for its explicit and scathing criticism of Mao and his policies during the period from 1959 to 1976, when he died. There is a certain parallel with the denunciation of Soviet Leader Josef Stalin and Stalinism by Khrushchev in February 1956 at the Twentieth Congress of the CPSU. Stalin's cult of personality was condemned, as were his crimes of persecuting, torturing and murdering his rivals. Though this has not been mentioned in the 1981 Resolution, it clearly had a significant impact on the CPC. Soon after the condemnation of Stalin by the CPSU in February 1956, the Central Committee of the CPC later in May that year